

Tran Zha

Software Engineering Manager | Platform Modernisation | Technical Leadership

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Professional Summary

Engineering Manager and hands-on software engineering leader with 15+ years of experience building software products, leading teams and modernising complex platforms. I help teams make sense of messy legacy systems, turn unclear problems into practical delivery plans, and keep business-critical work moving without losing sight of quality.

My leadership style mirrors effective LLM engineering: clear intent, enough context, practical guardrails, measurable success and tight feedback loops. I use LLM tools in work and personal projects to speed up research, prototyping, documentation and analysis, while keeping human review and engineering judgement at the centre.

Key Skills

- **Software engineering leadership:** Engineering Manager, Software Engineering Manager, Engineering Lead, Technical Lead, people leadership, team coaching, hiring support, career development, performance conversations and 1:1 feedback.
 - **Delivery and stakeholder management:** Agile delivery, software delivery lifecycle, SDLC, roadmap planning, delivery ownership, scope and debt tradeoffs, executive communication, vendor management and cross team dependency management.
 - **Platform modernisation and architecture:** Strangler Fig migration, monolith decomposition, service boundaries, backward compatibility, REST APIs, CQRS, event-driven architecture, event sourcing, projection-based migrations, gRPC, clean architecture, Vertical Slice Architecture and domain modelling.
 - **Cloud, DevOps, security and data:** AWS, GCP, Kubernetes, EKS, Docker, GitHub Actions, Octopus, OpenTelemetry, observability, incident response, service reliability, PII data handling, ISO 27001 (ISO27001) and SOC 2 Type II (SOC2 Type 2)-aligned engineering practices, SQL Server, PostgreSQL, Snowflake, BigQuery and data migration.
 - **Hands-on engineering toolkit:** C# and .NET, REST APIs, SQL, React, Node.js, Next.js, Firebase, Supabase, Flutter, DevOps automation and AI-assisted prototyping.
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Leadership & AI-Aware Delivery Strengths

- **Prompt engineering / clear communication:** Turns blurry requests into explicit intent, tradeoffs, decisions and next steps so teams and stakeholders know what is actually being asked.
- **Context engineering / shared why:** Gives teams the background, constraints and business reasoning behind work, so implementation choices fit the problem instead of only the ticket.
- **Harness engineering / delivery guardrails:** Defines goals, boundaries, operating agreements, measurable success criteria, reusable skills and workflows, making "good" concrete so LLM harnesses and teams improve over iterations.
- **Loop engineering / autonomous improvement:** Uplifts teams through effective delegation, mentoring, capacity building and tight build, test, verify, deploy and feedback loops, helping people make local decisions and working myself out of the job.

Professional Experience

Engineering Manager, MyCRM Replatforming | Loan Market Group

Feb 2023 to Present

Selected initiative: Contact Replatform, centralising contact mutation and retrieval

- Leading the highest-complexity MyCRM replatform initiative: contacts are entangled across more than half of the monolith's business logic, with historical edge cases and patches spread across screens, workflows and services.
- Building Contact v2 with backward compatibility and future-facing architecture, while untangling fragmented product logic into centralised mutation and retrieval paths and clearer ownership and authorisation boundaries.
- Using a Strangler Fig approach: facade over the existing data store first, gradual migration of legacy consumers, then replacement of the underlying data model once behaviours are controlled.
- Positioning Contact as a reference architecture for future MyCRM work, applying CQRS, domain and integration events, gRPC internal communication, clean architecture, Vertical Slice Architecture and stronger service boundaries.
- Partnering with product, architecture and frontend teams to introduce a new Material UI-based design system while preserving legacy interoperability during migration.

Selected initiative: Diversified Deals Replatform, generic engagement model for financial deals

- Led replatforming of residential-focused deal capability into a generic Engagement model that can handle multiple product types to support business growth.
- Used the Engagement platform to launch asset finance, commercial and insurance deal journeys, expanding MyCRM beyond residential lending without duplicating core deal logic.
- Applied event-driven architecture and event-sourcing patterns with backward-compatible projections, allowing legacy and new deal journeys to evolve without breaking consumers.
- Drove domain modelling, transition planning, roadmap alignment and stakeholder tradeoffs across product, engineering and business groups.
- Reset expectations and delivery discipline in a struggling team, improving clarity, technical direction and execution focus across a long-running replatform program.

Engineering Manager, Commission System, Business Insights and Podium Data Migration | Loan Market Group

Mar 2021 to Apr 2023

- Built and led teams across commissions, reporting and analytics and acquisition migration programs; shaped business cases, roadmaps, discovery and delivery plans for complex domains.
- Evaluated Snowflake, Starburst, ThoughtSpot, BigQuery, Sisense and related platforms; separated data lake and warehouse concerns and delivered ingestion, transformation and reporting pipelines.
- Led migration work after acquisitions, including one-off and overnight delta pipelines using SSIS, TaskFactory, Salesforce, Kubernetes jobs and AWS services; supported onshore growth from ~10 to 30+ engineers.

Engineering Manager, MyCRM Platform Modernisation | Loan Market Group

Jul 2019 to Apr 2021

- Introduced OpenTelemetry, contextual logging, GitHub Actions and Octopus, improved local development workflows, and led containerisation and Kubernetes/EKS migrations.

Senior DevOps Engineer and Senior Engineer, MyCRM Launch and Cloud Modernisation | New Zealand Financial Services Group

Apr 2016 to Jun 2019

- Helped rebuild, launch and modernise MyCRM across Australia and New Zealand; migrated from on-premises to AWS, CI/CD and improved observability; coordinated security audit activity.
- Supported offshore expansion from 0 to 30+ engineers and QA staff; team mentoring and culture building; Scrum master for multiple teams.
- Managed cloud spend, software licensing and vendor cost inputs for the MyCRM platform, balancing operational needs with budget and delivery priorities.
- Supported production operations, incident response and service reliability for business-critical CRM systems, using monitoring and support feedback to drive continuous improvement.

Software Engineer | LifeDirect / Inform Holdings / Trade Me

Jul 2008 to Mar 2016

- Full-stack engineering across online insurance, internal admin, reporting, CRM and hosting operations; built quoting, application and underwriting workflows and mentored team members as the function grew.

Hands-On AI and LLM-Assisted Personal Projects

- **mqcyb.tranzha.com - Math Quiz / mqcyb:** Flutter learning app previously released on the App Store; used AI assistance for rapid feature iteration, UI refinement and content generation support.
- **transtags.tranzha.com - Bank transaction categorisation and tax returns:** React and Node.js product experiment for importing bank transactions, categorising spending and preparing tax return exports; explored Supabase before pausing the project.
- **sports.tranzha.com - Community sports registration and mini CRM:** Next.js, Node.js and Firebase app for registrations, participants and lightweight community operations management.
- **Roblox Autorun Obby:** Roblox game/prototype using AI-assisted scripting, level iteration and gameplay experimentation.

Education, Selected Coursework & Languages

Postgraduate Diploma in Science, Computer Science - University of Auckland | Bachelor of Science, Computer Science - University of Auckland | Bachelor of Commerce, Finance and Economics - University of Auckland

Selected coursework: AWS Solutions Architect Associate coursework (A Cloud Guru); Kubernetes Administrator coursework (Udemy); Machine Learning and Deep Learning coursework (Coursera/deeplearning.ai); Scrum Master training

Languages: English, Mandarin.